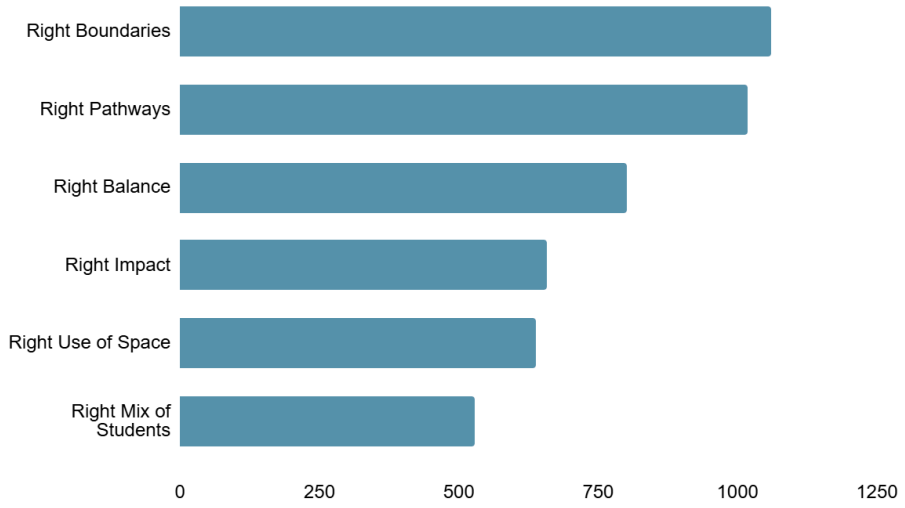
Board Engagement Summary:
Virtual Slido Opportunity
May 7-15, 2026

The Office of School Planning and Modernization shared a digital Slido poll to provide an opportunity for community members who were unable to attend an in-person or virtual engagement session to share feedback on PPS Rightsizing efforts. This poll was available in English, Spanish, Vietnamese, Chinese, Russian, and Somali. It was emailed to all members of the PPS community using ParentSquare, and was open from May 7 to May 15, 2026. This poll was open to anyone, regardless of whether they had attended an engagement session.

We estimate that about 1620 community members responded to this survey. Between 920 and 1620 people answered each question. About 70% of the people that responded were connected to grades K-5. Most of the respondents (75%) said their student(s) identify as white. Additionally, 13% of families identified as Asian, 13% identified as multiracial, 7% identified as Hispanic/Latinx, and 4% identified as Black/African American. Less than 2% each of respondents identified as American Indian/Alaska Native, Middle Eastern/North African, and/or Pacific Islander. About 10% of respondents declined to share the race/ethnicity of their student. About 40% of these families have students inTalented and Gifted programs. An additional 40% have students in Dual Language Immersion programs. In total, nearly a quarter (22%) of respondents experienced a school boundary change, a program relocation, or a grade level change within their school.

The PPS student assignment policy considers six main factors. People picked the three they thought were most important. The top priorities were *feeder patterns that allow as many students as possible to continue together from one school level to the next*, *boundaries that promote safer routes to schools,* and *program and enrollment stability.* (See **Chart 1** for the full results).

Chart 1:
Responses to the question, "Our Portland Public Schools Student Assignment Policy asks us to consider the following six factors. Please select the three most important factors to consider during program and enrollment balancing across our system." (1614 responses)



A total of 920 people answered a question about what helps students feel connected when they move schools. Families said that staying with the same group of neighborhood friends and classmates as they move to middle and high school is the most important factor for a child's mental health and safety. Additionally, the transition between schools is made smoother when principals, teachers, and counselors reach out early through summer camps, playground visits, and open houses before the school year even begins. Finally, a school feels like a supportive family when parents can easily volunteer, join PTA events, use the bike bus, and gather for neighborhood activities that build local trust.

Overall, the feedback showed that families who responded to this Slido want to focus on strong academics and student safety through this transition. Echoing common themes heard during budget engagement sessions, some families shared that they think the district has too many top-level managers, and they want leadership to cut central office salaries before laying off teachers or closing buildings. Commenters are worried about large class sizes, understaffed recesses, and a lack of support for students with special needs. While some agree that the district must make hard decisions to rightsize, others worry that closing neighborhood hubs or specialized language programs will destroy community trust and cause even more families to leave the district.